

Visual Identity Guidelines

STUDIO[®]
9DN

Studio9DN® Visual Identity Guidelines
© Copyright 2023.

ETHOS

We are very confident people; confident in our skills and abilities to deliver beyond what we've promised, confident in ourselves to flesh out the seemingly lofty ideas and confident in the partnerships we directly and indirectly build with the people that come in contact with us.

BRAND ADJECTIVES

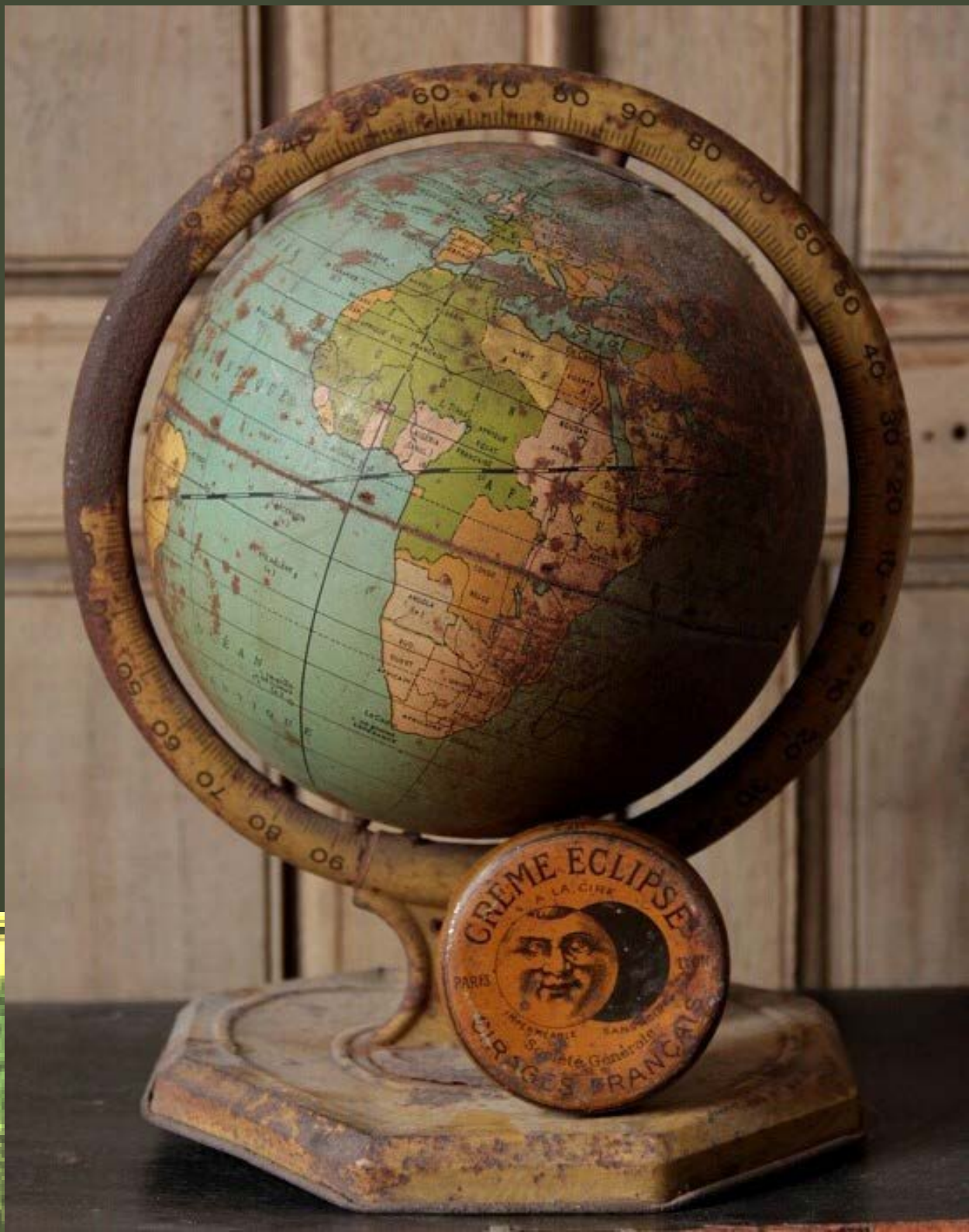
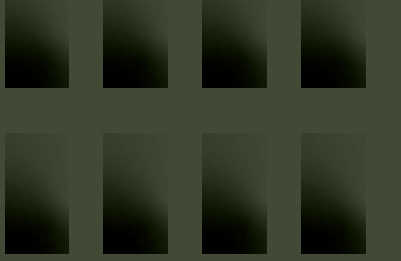
We are creative, driven and detail-oriented

BRAND VALUES

We never compromise on quality, performance and sustainability.



We are an independent design practice focused on tropical architecture through a holistic take on building performance.



(1)

OurName

Our brand name, Studio9DN, has more to it than meets the eye. It pays homage to our roots from both positioning and place perspectives. First off, the '9DN' is an abridged version of '9 Degrees North'—one of the lines of the latitude of the birthplace of the practice.

The rationale for using meridians in the first place or using a line of latitude over to other meridians is that we see architecture as markers for clusters of ideals (settlements or countries) keyed to co-ordinates. These co-ordinates are a unique combination of meridians of which the lines of latitude indicate what parts of the Earth are tropical. Consequently, '9 Degrees North', a line of latitude, simultaneously referencing the birthplace of the practice and its niche in architecture is completely suitable for the brand name.



Studio
9DN

The Studio9DN® brand identity speaks to a more mature crowd of real estate firms and individuals with the rock solid economic standing with an acquired taste for fine design details. What results is a brand identity infused with delicate treatment backed by a resilient outlook.

The exaggerated flourishes in the '9' and 'N' references the silhoutte of swooping beach palms—the most ubiquitous tropical trees and movement of collected precipitation; water.The existence of multiple variations other than the primary lockup makes for optimal versatility as different scenarios present themselves.

The Primary Lockup should be used as frequently as possible throughout brand collaterals. The secondary lockups and any other lockups should be used when the space is limited such as the Studio9DN® website.



PRIMARY LOCKUP

STUDIO®
9DN

(II)

Brand Logo

Alternative Lockups

The Studio9DN® brand mark also includes tertiary graphic elements such as a the name short-form, icons and badges.

These graphic elements are a great way to reinforce the Studio9DN® brand in addition to the logo. Some application examples may include product stickers, stamps, website footer, merch, packaging or stationery.

PRIMARY LOCKUP



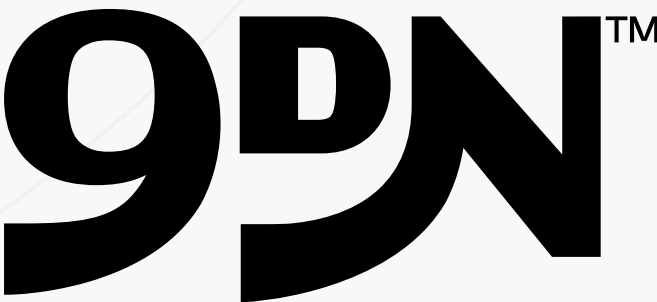
SECONDARY LOCKUP



OUTLINE LOCKUP



ICON-ONLY LOCKUP



BADGE LOCKUP

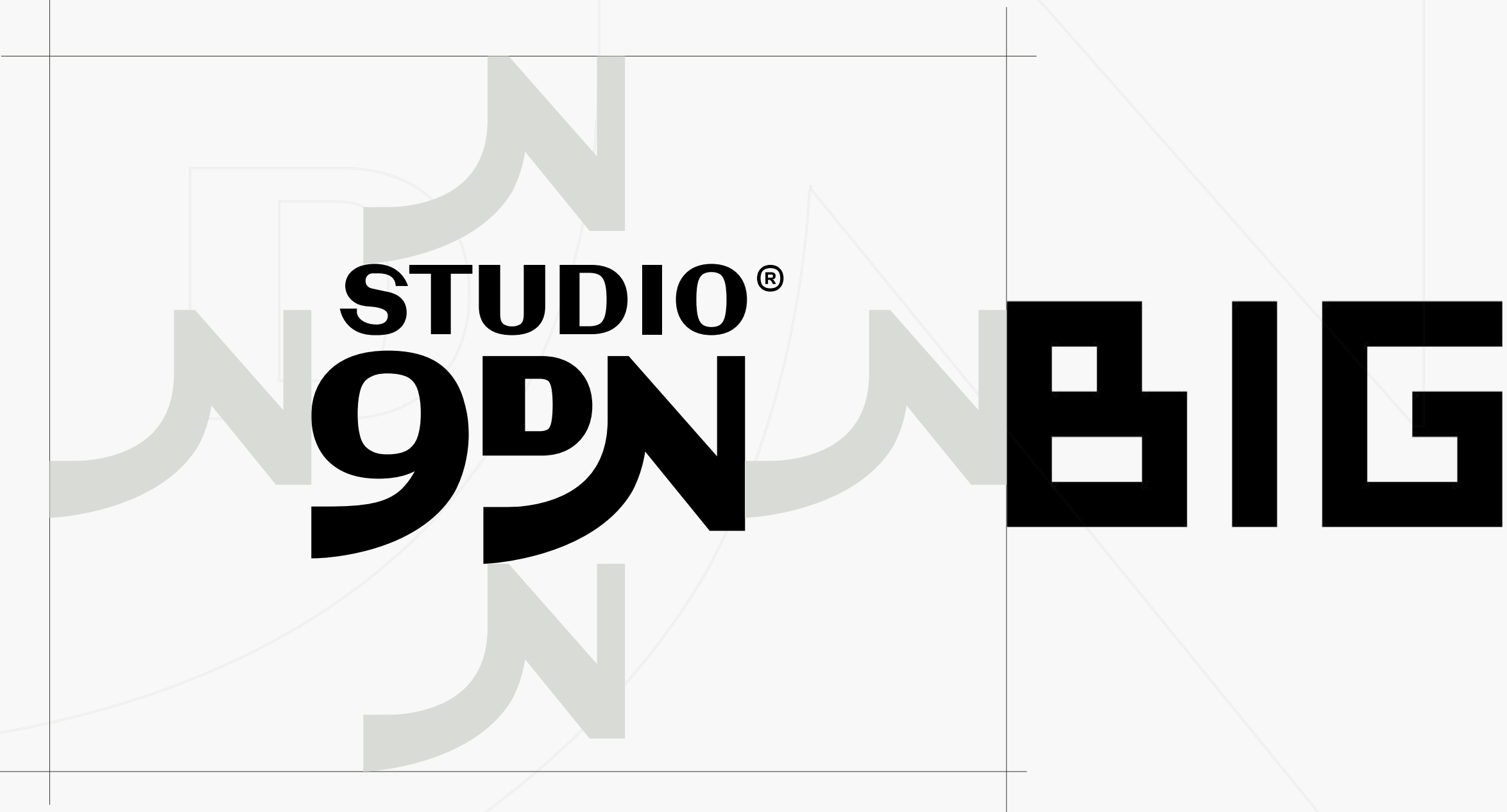


Clear Space

Clear space, or negative space, is the area that surrounds the logo and is clear of any other graphic elements. Clear space helps the logo to stand out from the rest of the elements on the page and ensures legibility, even at small sizes.

As a general rule, the more clear, or negative, space around the logo, the better.

At a minimum, there should be clear space equal to the height of the 'N' of the brand logo on all four sides of the logo. Using an element from the logo, as a unit of measurement, ensures enough clear space at any size.



ALTERNATIVE LOGO VERSION

There are no icons in any the iterations of the brand logo. Each version of the logo has its own logo size to determine clear space starting from the height of the 'N' in the brand logo.



Partnership Lockups

We would always be partnering up—from upcoming indigenous artists and artisans to big names like Bjarke Ingels Group.

Aligning partnership lockups should follow clear space rules. The seperating line between logos can be created using the width of the 'N' on the left and right sides, and its height on the top and bottom (just as shown in the clear space rules)



MINIMUM SIZE

Sizes in partnership lockups are tricky to predict. When in doubt, stick to the approved height of .31" for print and 23px for digital applications.



Colour Variations

Each brand logo lockup has several colour variations for use on different background types, tones and colours.

When in doubt, use the most legible version i.e the combination with the most contrast for the available background.

For printed executions, special care should be given to ensure logo legibility on the final media or material used.

COLOURED ICON + DARK BACKGROUND



Icon: Yellow
Background: Navy/ Forest

COLOURED ICON + LIGHT BACKGROUND



Icon: Forest/ Yellow
Background: Navy/ Yellow

SINGLE COLOUR, DARK



Icon: Forest/ Navy/ Yellow
Background: Transparent

SINGLE COLOUR, LIGHT



Icon: Forest
Background: Transparent

Incorrect Usage

Contrast is the name of the game when considering placing the logo on any background.

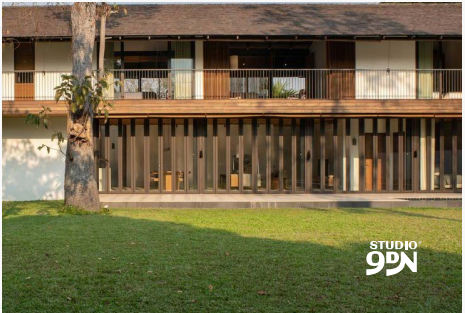
Our logo should not only be legible, it should also make a clear, strong statement when used. If there's no enough contrast between the logo and the background, the presence of the logo is weakened.

The logo may be placed on photographs, textures and patterns as long as there is enough contrast for the logo to be visible.

Note: This is not a comprehensive list of errors. These are simply the most common errors.



The one-colour version of the logo may be used on any solid colour background. Use the dark or light versions to acheive maximum contrast.



The one-colour, light version of the logo may be used on any dark photographic background. Do not use the two-colour version on any photographs.



Don't stetch, skew or squash the logo in any way.



Do not edit the logo colour; use an off-brand colour or reduce the logo's opacity.



The black, white or any of the coloured versions of the logo may be used on any light or dark photographic background, depending on which provides the most contrast. Do not use a two-colour version on any photographs.



The one-colour the logo may be used on low contrast pattern backgrounds. Use the dark or light versions to acheive maximum contrast.



Do not add any graphic effects to the logo including shadows.



Do not encroach on the required clear space surrounding the logo.

(II)

Brand Colours

Colours are precious to us as they deepen the meaning of our messages. Just like all of our brand assets, cultural elements are the guides for most of our brand decisions. You would observe this in the way our brand colours are named and how these names are tied to the environmental elements existent in almost any culture of the world.

Attention to detail is innate to us and so, our brand colours were picked from the PANTONE + Colour Bridge Coated colour book for coherence across all our touchpoints.

For flexibility of use, tints of all the brand colours could be used. We would also recommend that an excellent amount of contrast should be strived for when choosing or combining the tints.

When printing on office stock stationery we would recommend, for cohesion, that you reference the CMYK numbers. And for special paper stock, please reference the Pantone FHI Paper TPG colour book for equivalents.

Forest

PANTONE BLACK 3 UP

HEX: # 434A36
RGB: 76, 74, 54
CMYK: 65, 51, 76, 46

USING BLACK AND WHITE

Black and white are vital components to the brand palette. Whenever possible, avoid the use of true black and white in favour of these subdued tones.

Both white and black are used to define space on the page, the package and on the website.

Create high contrast by combining both perfect for legible typography. This guide serves as an excellent of this.

We recommend the expansive use of negative space in brand executions, which can be created by using either white or black.

USING TINTS

We prefer our brand colour used without editing, but some situations require the use of colour tints, especially in the web. For example, when hovering over buttons on our website, using a tint change can help confirm their actions.

If necessary, use a 20% step system, keeping legibility in mind. Any tint below 60% should be used as a background and will require dark text.

Clash Grotesk

PRIMARY TYPEFACE

Rowan

SECONDARY TYPEFACE

(III)

Brand Typeface

Few things communicate the look and feel of a brand more clearly than the way letters, numbers and symbols, are put together. We believe typography should strike a balance between legibility and interest, hence our reason for choosing Clash Grotesk and Rowan as primary and secondary typefaces for Studio9DN®

Both typefaces are made by the Indian Type Foundry and are open source, meaning that they are free to use nearly all possible scenarios. All the weights, in their appropriate formats, as well as their licenses would be made available to you. Nonetheless, they are available for download on fontshare.com

Hierarchy & Weights

Clash Grotesk and Rowan are variable weight typefaces, which means you are able to cutomze weights and angles to create an infinite number of weights. That being said, we typically stay within these four weights.

Use contrast between heavy and lighter weights to communicate relevant importance, otherwise known as hierarchy, of information.

H1	USE CASES: • Page Headings • Master Section Headings • Emphasized Words SPECIFICS: • FONT: Clash Grotesk • SIZE: 72pt • BOTTOM MARGIN: 60pt
H2	USE CASES: • Section Headings • Blog Body Headings • Product Headings SPECIFICS: • FONT: Rowan Light Italic • SIZE: 24pt • BOTTOM MARGIN: 24pt
H3	USE CASES: • Sub-Headings • Call-To-Action Headings • Blog Sub-Headings SPECIFICS: • FONT: Clash Grotesk Medium • SIZE: 18pt • BOTTOM MARGIN: 18pt
H4	USE CASES: • Minor Headings • Table Labels • Sub Sub-Headings SPECIFICS: • FONT: Rowan Semi-Bold • SIZE: 9pt • BOTTOM MARGIN: 9pt
Body	USE CASES: • Body Copy • Paragraphs SPECIFICS: • FONT: Clash Grotesk • SIZES: 12/14pts • BOTTOM MARGIN: 14,4/16.8pts

The Six Meridians

When constructing layouts, these tips would help you build dynamic, interesting and on-brand compositions with typography.

While these rules are proven and sound, breaking them is sometimes the right call.

STAY LEFT-ALIGNED, RAG RIGHT

Legibility and clarity are vitally important to great typographical layouts. Since most people read from left to right, we should align our type accordingly. And besides, we're a little off center as a brand anyways.

ALIGN X-HEIGHTS OR BASELINES

Whenever you place text next to each other, either align the baselines (the line that the bottom of a lowercase x sits on) or align the x-heights (the top of the lowercase x). This helps align each line visually.

GIVE THINGS SPACE, IF NEEDED

Negative space, or the space that is around elements is vitally important. That being said, if informational elements belong together, move them closer together. Use grouping wisely: just try not to cram many things in one space.

SKIP WEIGHTS & DOUBLE SIZE

Contrast is the name of the game when it comes to great design. When in doubt, skip a weight or two when paring two weights, and double the size between two text elements.

WATCH THE RAG

When setting paragraphs, keep an eye on the right (ragged). If the rag unintentionally creates a recognizable shape, consider tweaking the language or resizing the container. Also, try to prevent single word lines (orphans).

KEEP THE LINE LENGTH REASONABLE

It is easy for the users to get lost in long lines of text, and short ones are easily ignored. It is best to keep lines between 45 and 70 characters long, depending on the size of the font. This will ensure legibility as font sizes increase or decrease.

